

MARKET STATE · MACRO REGIME

Live macro context — sourced unavailable (coreyLive context unavailable).

EVENT CLUSTERS

US · USD BLOCK · 2 EVENTS HIGH

HIGH IMPACT

CPI (USD)

20:00 AWST · 12:00 UTC · USD

Inflation reading — rate-path lever for USD and yields.

FORECAST  
3.2%

PREVIOUS  
3.0%

WHY THIS MATTERS

Hotter-than-forecast readings historically tend to support USD and yields (rates expected to stay higher for longer), pressuring gold and risk indices. Cooler readings favour the reverse rotation.

MARKET IMPACT · TRANSMISSION CHAIN

cause: USD inflation surprise vs forecast → expectation: rate-path repricing in the front end → market reaction: USD and yields move first → asset impact: US Dollar Index (DXY) direction sets gold and US-index reaction

BEFORE · DURING · AFTER

BEFORE Market is positioning around the 3.2% consensus; USD pairs and yields are most sensitive.

DURING First reaction may be a liquidity sweep. Above forecast supports USD / yields; below forecast pressures both.

AFTER A 5M / 15M [Confirmed candle close] in surprise direction validates continuation. Reassess only after that close.

CONFIRMS

US Dollar Index (DXY) / yields lead; a [Confirmed candle close] on 5M / 15M in surprise direction validates.

CANCELS

First reaction reverses inside 30M; pre-release reference area lost; directional read cancelled.

HISTORICAL REACTION

sourced unavailable (no historical sample sourced for CPI (USD))

MEDIUM IMPACT

Fed Speech

22:00 AWST · 14:00 UTC · USD

\$ DOLLAR IMPACT RANGE · CPI (USD)

First-60-second swing range:

- **\$500 - \$1,000** on \$100k EURUSD lot
- **\$1,200 - \$2,500** on 1 standard XAUUSD lot (100 oz)
- **\$400 - \$900** on 100 shares US large-cap
- **\$600 - \$1,200** on \$100k USDJPY lot
- **\$300 - \$750** on NAS100 mini (per pt × 5)

**Post-settle trend move:** \$700 - \$1,500 trend move on \$100k EURUSD over the T+5 → T+90 window

basis: scenario estimate (historical analogue cache not yet wired)

⊗ REACTION PATHS · 4 OUTCOMES · CPI (USD)

HAWKISH

IF HIGHER than forecast (hawkish-for-USD)

AFFECTED MARKETS

US Dollar Index EURUSD GBPUSD USDJPY XAUUSD NAS100 US500

EXPECTED BEHAVIOUR

- US Dollar Index pushes higher — buyers pile into the dollar
- USD pairs respond first on rate-path repricing
- US indices (NAS100 / US500) drop on rate-hike fears
- Gold initially nasps; can recover on safe-haven flow if surprise extreme

\$ DOLLAR IMPACT (FIRST 30 MIN POST-RELEASE)

- **Long USD positions:** \$300 - \$800 gain (favoured)
- **Short USD positions:** \$300 - \$800 drawdown (pressured)
- **Long XAUUSD trades:** \$500 - \$1,500 drawdown (pressured)

WHAT YOU SHOULD DO

- ✓ After the 5-min close at T+5, look for SHORT positions in the dominant USD direction using the next Dark Horse scan
- ✓ Exit losing positions against the surprise direction on the T+5 close if direction holds

WHAT YOU SHOULD NOT DO

- ✗ Do NOT enter fresh positions in the first 5 minutes — chase risk is high
- ✗ Do NOT add to any positions against the surprise direction

DOVISH

IF LOWER than forecast (dovish-for-USD)

AFFECTED MARKETS

US Dollar Index EURUSD GBPUSD USDJPY XAUUSD NAS100 US500

EXPECTED BEHAVIOUR

- US Dollar Index pulls back — sellers exit dollar longs
- USD pairs reverse on rate-path repricing
- US indices rally on rate-cut optimism
- Gold rises with broader risk-on flow

\$ DOLLAR IMPACT (FIRST 30 MIN POST-RELEASE)

- **Long USD positions:** \$300 - \$800 drawdown (pressured)
- **Short USD positions:** \$300 - \$800 gain (favoured)
- **Long XAUUSD trades:** \$500 - \$1,500 gain (favoured)

WHAT YOU SHOULD DO

- ✓ After the 5-min close at T+5, look for LONG positions in the dominant opposite-USD direction using the next Dark Horse scan
- ✓ Exit losing positions against the surprise direction on the T+5 close if direction holds

WHAT YOU SHOULD NOT DO

- ✗ Do NOT enter fresh positions in the first 5 minutes
- ✗ Do NOT add to any positions against the surprise direction

INLINE

IF IN-LINE with forecast / market pricing

AFFECTED MARKETS

light reaction across the board

EXPECTED BEHAVIOUR

- Initial spike either side then settle. No clean directional bias.
- Volatility drops within 15 minutes.
- Markets refocus on the next scheduled catalyst.

\$ DOLLAR IMPACT (FIRST 30 MIN POST-RELEASE)

- **\$100k EURUSD position:** \$100 - \$300 swings then mean-reversion (muted)

WHAT YOU SHOULD DO

- ✓ Stand aside through T+5. Re-read at next ATLAS scan.
- ✓ Re-engage normally once the next scheduled catalyst delivers.

WHAT YOU SHOULD NOT DO

- ✗ Do NOT trade the initial spike — it will settle.

REVERSAL

IF INITIAL-DIRECTION REVERSAL · the first move reverses within 10 minutes

AFFECTED MARKETS

US Dollar Index EURUSD GBPUSD USDJPY XAUUSD NAS100 US500

EXPECTED BEHAVIOUR

- The first direction off the release is faded by T+10.
- Volume comes IN against the initial move.
- The 15-min close at T+15 is the real trend, not the first 60-second spike.
- Happens roughly 1 in 4 high-impact releases — more often in elevated-volatility regimes.

\$ DOLLAR IMPACT (FIRST 30 MIN POST-RELEASE)

- **Trades chasing the first 60 seconds (any direction):** \$800 - \$1,500 drawdown (pressured)

WHAT YOU SHOULD DO

- ✓ Wait for the 15-min candle close at T+15.
- ✓ Trade only the post-T+15 direction — that is the actual signal.

WHAT YOU SHOULD NOT DO

- ✗ Do NOT trade the first move under any circumstance.
- ✗ Do NOT add to positions on the initial direction inside T+10.

⚠ RISK ESCALATION · TIME-WINDOWED BEHAVIOUR

PRE-EVENT

HEALTHY · normal trade-management with one change

now → T-5

Reduce all positions in affected pairs to 60% of normal size by T-5. Use this window to close losing trades and tighten exits on winners.

**\$ \$ cost:** Cost of staying full-size into T-0: \$200 - \$400 extra drawdown on a \$100k notional position from wider whips alone.

**Action:** Tighten exits. Close losers. Cut size to 60%.

T-5

CAUTION · final lead-in

T-5 → T-0

Close any open positions UNLESS they are >1.5R in profit AND your exit is already at break-even.

**\$ \$ cost:** Open positions face \$500 - \$1,000 first-minute swing risk on \$100k notional at T-0.

**Action:** Tighten exits to break-even or step aside.

T-0

DANGER · the release moment

T-0 → T+5

Markets routinely whip \$500 - \$1,000 against any position on \$100k notional in the first 60 seconds.

**\$ \$ cost:** \$500 - \$1,200 first-60s swing risk on \$100k notional.

**Action:** Stand aside. Watch the 5-min candle close. Do NOT trade.

STAND-ASIDE-IF-CHAIN

STAND ASIDE · if a clustered catalyst chain emerges

if multi-catalyst chain forms

If this release combines with another high-impact event inside the same session window, expected combined post-event move re-prices for the rest of the session.

**\$ \$ cost:** \$1,500 - \$3,000 combined-window move on \$100k notional.

**Action:** Wait for the 15-min close AFTER the FINAL catalyst before resuming new trades.

RE-ENTRY

RE-ENTRY · post-settle resumption

T+5 onwards

Re-read structure on the 5m chart. Match against the reaction paths. Act only on setups where price closes beyond the trigger AND the next candle holds beyond it (confirmed directional structure test).

**\$ \$ cost:** Continued 60% size until the next scheduled catalyst delivers; resume normal sizing only after.

**Action:** Trade only confirmed-candle-close direction at 60% size.

👁 WHAT TRADERS SHOULD WATCH

PRE-EVENT INDICATORS (NOW → T-5)

- **US Dollar Index above 105:** The dollar has ALREADY moved up in anticipation of a hawkish read. Action: do NOT bet on further dollar strength unless the release surprises EVEN HOTTER than expected. The easy long-dollar trade is already priced in.
- **Front-end yields above 4.85%:** The bond market is also already positioned for a hawkish reading. Same as DXY above — be cautious of fresh long-dollar entries.
- **CBOE Volatility Index above 18:** Traders are nervous about the release. Equity downside risk is elevated. Do NOT take fresh long-equity positions before T-0.
- **CBOE Volatility Index below 14:** Traders are complacent. A surprise reading will hit harder. Avoid new positions in any market until T+5.
- **USD pair at the high or low of its 24h range entering T-0:** The market is leaning directionally. A surprise against that leaning causes the BIGGEST whips. Cut size further if the lead pair is at an extreme entering T-0.

DURING THE EVENT (T-0 → T+5)

- **The first 60 seconds of price action:** It is NOISE. Do not act on it. *Action: Stand aside.*
- **The 5-min candle CLOSE at T+5:** That prints the real direction. Read US Dollar Index first, THEN look at USD / XAUUSD response. *Action: Wait for the close. Read DXY first.*

POST-EVENT REASSESSMENT (T+5 ONWARDS)

- **Did the initial direction HOLD or REVERSE inside 10 minutes?:** If reversed: trade only the post-T+15 direction. The initial move was wrong.
- **Is volume CONFIRMING the move or FADING?:** Confirming = sustained large candle bodies in the direction. Fading = candle bodies shrinking — direction is exhausting. Only enter trades when volume is confirming.
- **What did treasuries do?:** Bonds move opposite to yields. If yields jumped, bonds fell — that confirms a HAWKISH read. Trade in line with bonds for the cleanest signal.
- **Next scheduled catalyst proximity:** If another high-impact catalyst is within 2 hours, small size or stand aside through the inter-catalyst window.

📖 EVENT-DAY REFERENCE · 4 WINDOWS

Before the release, candles are small and quiet (pre-event window). At T-0 the candle range explodes — that is the chaos window. By T+5 the noise settles and a clear direction emerges. From T+30 onwards, candles return to normal size and the trend is tradable.

PRE-EVENT **T-30 → T-0** — small, quiet 5m candles.

**\$ \$100 - \$300 whips per 5m candle on \$100k EURUSD.**

Action: Size at 60% of normal. Tighten exits..

T-0 CHAOS **T-0 → T+5** — candle range explodes — outlier ranges.

**\$ \$500 - \$1,000 swings in 60 seconds on \$100k notional.**

Action: Stand aside. Do NOT trade..

POST-SETTLE **T+5 → T+30** — noise settles, clear direction emerges.

**\$ \$200 - \$400 per 5m candle (settling).**

Action: Re-read direction. Trade only the confirmed-candle-close direction..

RESUME **T+30 onwards** — candles return to normal size; trend tradable.

**\$ \$50 - \$150 per 5m candle (normal).**

Action: Resume normal trading patterns..

MARKET IMPACT · TRANSMISSION CHAIN

cause: USD inflation surprise vs forecast → expectation: rate-path repricing in the front end → market reaction: USD and yields move first → asset impact: US Dollar Index (DXY) direction sets gold and US-index reaction Lead currency block: USD.

AFFECTED MARKETS

- **DXY**
- **USD pairs:** EURUSD, GBPUSD, USDJPY, USDCAD, USDCHF, AUDUSD
- **Metals:** XAUUSD
- **US indices:** NAS100, US500, US30

CONFIRMATION PATH

US Dollar Index (DXY) / yields lead; a [Confirmed candle close] on 5M / 15M in surprise direction validates.

CANCELLATION PATH

First reaction reverses inside 30M; pre-release reference area lost; directional read cancelled.

OPERATOR GUIDANCE

**Confirms:** US Dollar Index (DXY) / yields lead; a [Confirmed candle close] on 5M / 15M in surprise direction validates.

**Cancels:** First reaction reverses inside 30M; pre-release reference area lost; directional read cancelled.

HISTORICAL REACTION · LEAD EVENT

Historical reaction — sourced unavailable (no historical sample sourced for CPI (USD)).

📊 WHY THIS RATING · WHAT CHANGES IT

**Why this rating, not lower or higher:** Rating would be ●●●●● 4/5 — ELEVATED if a second high-impact catalyst joined the window. Rating would be ●●●●● 2/5 — CALM if today were driver-led only.

**What changes this state:**

- If a central-bank rate decision is added: state climbs to ●●●●● 5/5 — EXTREME.
- If any scheduled high-impact event cancels: state drops one tier.
- If geopolitical risk escalates inside the session: state climbs one tier (safe-haven rotation overrides driver-led tape).
- If yield curve un-flattens beyond 0.60: cyclical rotation re-prices — direction read flips.

📋 BRIEFING ACTIONS

1. Cut all positions in affected pairs to 60% of normal size by T-5 of CPI (USD) (20:00 AWST · 12:00 UTC).
2. Stand aside from T-0 to T+5 — the chaos window. Watch the 5-min candle close at T+5.
3. Re-read direction on the T+5 close against the 4 reaction paths above.
4. Trade only the post-settle direction at 60% size until the next scheduled catalyst delivers.
5. ATLAS Market Intel next tick updates at the next scheduled 5-minute interval.

📖 EXPANDED TERMINOLOGY

Dovish Hawkish Yield curve Risk-off Liquidity sweep Confirmed candle close